2025 national curriculum tests

Key stage 2

English grammar, punctuation and spelling

Paper 1: questions

First name						
Middle name						
Last name						
Date of birth	Day		Month		Year	
School name						
DfE number						

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Please do not write on this page.

Instructions

Questions and answers

There are different types of question for you to answer in different ways. The space for your answer shows you what type of answer is needed. Write your answer in the space provided. Do not write over any barcodes.

Multiple-choice answers
For some questions, you do not need to do any writing. Read the instructions carefully so that you know how to answer each question.

Short answers
Some questions are followed by a line or a box. This shows that you need to write a word, a few words or a sentence.

Marks

The number under each line at the side of the page tells you the number of marks available for each question.

You should work through the booklet until you are asked to stop.

Work as quickly and as carefully as you can. If you finish before the end, go back and check your work.

You have 45 minutes to answer the questions in this booklet.

1 What does the **prefix** anti- mean in the word anticlockwise?

Tick **one**.

- never ☐
- opposite ☑
- before ☐
- without ☐

1

1 mark

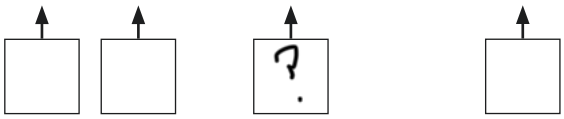
2 Circle the word that is a **synonym** of the word bumpy.

uneven sore smooth low

1 mark

3 Tick **one** box to show where a **question mark** is needed in the sentence below.

“ Have you finished eating your lunch ” asked Hannah



1 mark

4 Tick one box in each row to show whether the sentence is a **statement** or a **command**.

Sentence	Statement	Command
Watch where you’re going.		✓
We watched the game together.	✓	
My watch stopped working.	✓	
Do not watch too much television.		✓

1 mark

5 Insert two **commas** in the correct places in the sentence below.

We lifted up the log and found worms woodlice snails and slugs.

1 mark

6 Which punctuation mark could be used at the end of the sentence below?

I can't wait to look after the school rabbit for the weekend

Tick **one**.

- a question mark ☐
- a comma ☐
- an exclamation mark ☑
- a colon ☐

1 mark

N 0 0 0 3 0 A 0 6 2 8

7 Circle the correct **verb form** in each underlined pair to complete the sentences below using **Standard English**.

We was / were going on a school trip to a concert.

The musicians did / done a sound check before the show.

1 mark

8 Insert a **semi-colon** in the correct place in the sentence below.

We have been learning about the Vikings they were a fascinating civilisation.

1 mark

9 Tick all the sentences that must end with a **question mark**.

Tick **all** the correct responses.

How good it would be if Jay could come ☑

Is Jay going to come on Tuesday ☑

Jay asked if we could meet him on Tuesday ☐

Do you know if Jay is coming on Tuesday ☑

1 mark

10 Insert a pair of **brackets** in the correct place in the sentence below.

Our class visited a castle (the oldest in the country) to help us with our history project.

1 mark

11 Circle the most **formal** option in each underlined pair below to complete the passage.

The basketball club was set up / established by a group of friends last year.

They invited / got people who were interested in the game to join.

Now they play / compete in their local league.

1 mark

fronted ?

12 Which sentence starts with an **adverbial**?

Tick **one**.

She is feeling tired, so Kal is going to her room. ☐

After dinner, Kal is going to her room. ☑

Arun told me that Kal is going to her room. ☐

I wonder when Kal is going to her room. ☐

1 mark

13 Which sentence is the most **formal**?

Tick **one**.

I can't wait for the game tomorrow! ☐

Kick-off is at 2pm. ☑

The coach has yet to announce the team. ☐

I really hope I'll be playing! ☐

1 mark

14 What punctuation could be used instead of **brackets** in the sentence below?

Tokyo (the capital of Japan) is one of the largest cities in the world.

Tick **one**.

hyphens ☐

colons ☐

semi-colons ☑

dashes ☐

1 mark

15 Insert a **colon** in the correct place in the sentence below.

We saw various animals on our evening walk badgers, foxes, mice and an owl.

1 mark

16 Circle the three **adjectives** in the passage below.

The crumbling castle stood high on the rocky hill. The views over the countryside were glorious.

1 mark

17 Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

Tick **one**.

Swimming, which strengthens muscles in the arms, and legs is great exercise. [X]

Swimming, which strengthens muscles in the arms and legs, is great exercise. [ ]

Swimming which strengthens muscles, in the arms and legs, is great exercise. [ ]

Swimming which strengthens, muscles in the arms and legs, is great exercise. [✓]

1 mark

18 Use the information in the box to complete the sentence below with a **relative clause**.
Remember to punctuate your answer correctly.

My uncle, who lives on the farm, is going to

1 mark

My uncle lives on a farm.

plant potatoes.

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19 In which sentence is space a **verb**?

Tick **one**.

Make space on the table for the laptop. ☐

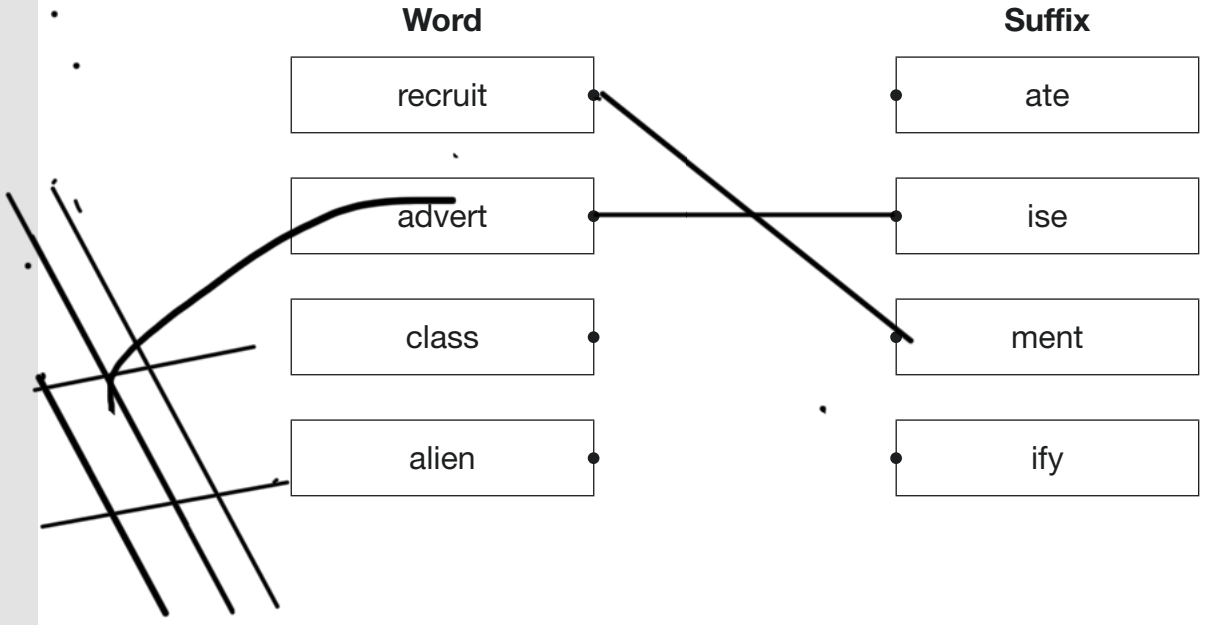
Space yourselves out in the hall for PE. ☐

Our new playground has more space for lining up. ☐

Space is an interesting science topic. ☐

1 mark

20 Draw a line to match each word to a **suffix** to create another word.



1 mark

21 Why is there an **apostrophe** in the sentence below?

Who's been eating my ice cream?

Tick **one**.

- to show that who's is the contracted form of 'who is' ☐
- to show singular possession ☑
- to show that who's is the contracted form of 'who has' ☐
- to show plural possession ☐

1 mark

22 Which sentence uses a comma after a **fronted adverbial**?

Tick **one**.

- We studied the menu at the noisy, crowded ice cream parlour. ☐
- When the waitress came over, I asked which flavours were the most popular. ☑
- I chose chocolate, Mum chose strawberry and Dad chose vanilla. ☐
- My ice cream was covered in nuts, chocolate chips and toffee sauce. ☐

1 mark

23 Insert a **dash** in the correct place in the sentence below.

I must repair my backpack the zip is broken and I need it for our camping trip.

1 mark

24 What is the grammatical term for the underlined words in the sentence below?

In 1961, the first manned spaceflight took place although a dog called Laika had travelled into space four years earlier.

Tick **one**.

- a noun phrase ☐
- a relative clause ☒
- a preposition phrase ☐
- a subordinate clause ☒

1 mark

25 Tick one box in each row to show if the underlined clause is a **main clause** or a **subordinate clause**.

Sentence	Main clause	Subordinate clause
I walked to school with Hazel <u>as we live on the same road</u>.		
<u>Hazel uses a wheelchair</u> so we went up the ramp.		
<u>Before we entered the classroom</u>, we greeted our friends.		

1 mark

26 Draw a line to match each sentence to its **form**.

Sentence	Form
Are you coming to the film night at school	question
What a shame you can't come	command
Don't worry about it	statement
There will be another one next term	exclamation

1 mark

N 0 0 0 3 0 A 0 1 6 2 8

27 Which sentence has a **modal verb**?

Tick **one**.

Please help me find the blue pencils. ☐

What are we having for lunch? ☐

Alex had been yawning all day. ☐

I must be at school early tomorrow. ☑

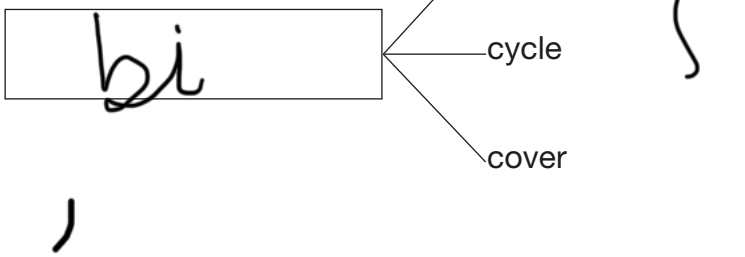
1 mark

28 Explain why the word they makes the meaning of the sentence unclear.

When Kate and Ravi met the other tennis players, they were excited.

1 mark

29 Which **prefix** could be added to all three words below to make new words?



1 mark

30 Insert a **hyphen** in the correct place in the sentence below.

At the museum, we enjoyed dressing up in the old fashioned costumes and fancy hats.

1 mark

31 Insert **inverted commas** in the correct places in the passage below.

I think it is over here shouted Reena , pointing at the map .
Follow me !

1 mark

32 Tick one box in each row to show whether the underlined word is a **verb**, a **noun** or an **adjective**.

Sentence	Verb	Noun	Adjective
He folds the letter carefully.			
The folded letter was put in the envelope.			
The letter had folds in it.			

1 mark

33 Explain how the **comma** changes the meaning of the second sentence.

1. Did you call Raheem?

2. Did you call, Raheem?

Now you have to take a pause

1 mark

34 Underline the **relative clause** in the sentence below.

After her dance class, Jamila has a strawberry milkshake, which she buys from the local cafe.

1 mark

35 Circle the **preposition** in each sentence below.

Stef trained hard before the hockey tournament.

Concentrating intensely, Emma hit the ball into the net.

1 mark

36 Circle the **subject** of the sentence below.

After the heavy rain, Mum decided not to water the garden.

1 mark

37 Rewrite the sentence below in the **passive**.
Remember to punctuate your answer correctly.

Someone stole the treasure.

The treasure has been stole by someone

1 mark

38 Complete the passage below with the **simple past** of the verbs in the boxes.

I brought my violin to school. I forgoten it last week.

1 mark

to bring	to forget

39 Circle the three **nouns** in the sentence below.

He played the piano with great confidance and rarely made mistakes.

1 mark

40 Which **word class** is the underlined word in the sentence below?

On sunny days, Ben <u>often</u> plays outside before dinner.

Tick **one**.

- an adverb ☑
- a conjunction ☐
- an adjective ☐
- a determiner ☐

1 mark

41 Write a **noun phrase** containing at least three words to complete the sentence below.
Remember to punctuate your answer correctly.

_____ opened the door.

1 mark

42 Insert **full stops** and **capital letters** in the passage below so it is punctuated correctly.

This year, we have been on a number of school trips my favourite was to the Science Museum because we saw some incredible experiments however, Elise preferred our visit to Colchester Castle .

1 mark

43 Rewrite the sentence below in the **active**.
Remember to punctuate your answer correctly.

The local park is maintained by the council.

1 mark

44 Circle the **possessive pronoun** in each sentence below.

Dad told me that Mum's favourite sport is cycling and his is cricket.

Tennis is Karen's favourite sport and mine is football.

1 mark

45 Circle all the **conjunctions** in the passage below.

Since Billy has started swimming lessons, he has been going to the pool every Saturday and sometimes on Wednesdays too, if his dad has time to take him.

1 mark

46 Circle the verb that is in the **subjunctive** in the sentence below.

If I were to help, I would start by clearing the tables.

1 mark

47 Circle the three **determiners** in the sentence below.

There are some biscuits in this tin but there are not any chocolate ones.

1 mark

48 Complete the sentence below using the **past progressive** form of the verb in the box.

While we _____ to our friend, his phone started ringing.

1 mark

to talk

49 Circle the **adverb** in the sentence below.

Although Jane was a speedy runner, she was almost beaten in the race.

1 mark

50 Complete the sentence below with the **past perfect** form of the verb in the box.

The teacher told the class that he has decided not to give them any homework.

1 mark

to decide

Standards & Testing Agency

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Print version product code: STA/25/8914/p ISBN: 978-1-83507-245-5
Electronic PDF version product code: STA/25/8914/e ISBN: 978-1-83507-266-0

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